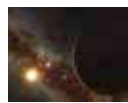




Hazzaa Ali Almansoori

UAE's first astronaut, Hazzaa, launched on his first space mission last month. <https://digit.in/oct19-81>



Unexpected planet

Astronomers discovered a massive Jupiter-like planet orbiting a red dwarf star, an unexpected combination. <https://digit.in/oct19-82>

Lenovo Legion Y540

A solid RTX 2060 gaming device

Price
₹1,27,150

Anyone familiar with the Lenovo Legion Y530 from last year will be able to tell that this year's Legion Y540 is simply a refresh and not a complete redesign. Let's find out how it did.

Build and design

The Legion Y540 undoubtedly builds on the subtle, classy design of its predecessor. At 2.3 kilogrammes, the Legion Y540 is quite heavy.

On the inside, we see a 15.6-inch matte-finish LCD panel with really slim black bezels on three sides. The display folds back all the way to 180 degrees, which we don't get to see on a lot of gaming laptops.

Display, audio and IO

The Legion Y540 comes with a 15.6-inch IPS LCD panel with Full HD resolution and 144Hz refresh rate. According to Lenovo, the display can manage 300 nits of brightness and reproduce 72 percent of the colours in the sRGB colour space.

Sound from the Legion Y540's two slanted front-firing speakers is surprisingly good. The maximum volume is sufficient for watching a short video in a quiet bedroom but falls short in say, a noisy office cubicle.

The Legion Y540, like its predecessor, has ports on the sides and back. On the left side, we see a USB-A 3.1 port and a single 3.5mm audio jack for headsets. On the right side, we see a single USB-A 3.1 port. On the back, which is a rather inconvenient place to have ports, we see a USB-C port, a Mini DisplayPort, a USB-A 3.1 port, a full-size HDMI port, a LAN port, and the proprietary power port.

Keyboard and touchpad

The keyboard on the Legion Y540 is something of a mixed bag in that the



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keys on it are large and easy to read but not exactly comfortable for typing long documents.

RGB backlight-lovers will be disappointed to see only a single white colour on offer. On the bright side, every row of keys is large including the top-most one.

The touchpad on the Legion Y540 is extremely easy to operate. It's large enough for clicks, taps, and swipes.

Performance

The review unit we received was the top-of-the-line variant, which costs approximately ₹1,27,150. It is powered by an Intel Core i7-9750H CPU with 16 GB of RAM and an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 2060 with 6 GB of VRAM. Storage came in the form of a 1TB Samsung PCIe NVMe solid-state drive. Users looking to expand storage get the option of adding a 2.5-inch hard drive.

The review unit fared remarkably well on our CPU and GPU benchmark tests. On PCMark 8's Conventional Creative test, the review unit bagged 5889, which is well above the average we have seen in the past in the same category. The Asus ROG Zephyrus M GU502, which was launched recently, scored 3952 in the same test. On 3DMark's Fire Strike Ultra and

Time Spy, the review unit scored 3462 and 5749 respectively. The Zephyrus M GU502, on the other hand, scored 3005 and 5281 in the same two tests respectively.

Gaming in native Full HD resolution was a pleasurable experience on the RTX 2060-powered Legion Y540. On the review unit, Doom ran on Ultra graphics settings (the highest in any game, by our definition) at an average frame rate of 140 frames per second, a figure that is bordering on the maximum refresh rate of the 144Hz LCD panel. The same game on High graphics settings (the second highest in any game, by our definition) ran at 141 frames per second, meaning there was practically no difference between the two settings.

While the underside and rear vents of the laptop got quite hot (49 degrees Celsius on average) during gaming sessions, very little of it was felt around the WASD keys (38 degrees Celsius on average). In a quiet conference room, the two fans could be heard when a game was running (approx. 60dB) but they weren't so loud that they distracted me from the game.

The 52.5Wh three-cell internal battery on the Legion Y540 is the weakest we have seen on a gaming laptop yet. On our standard battery benchmark test, the review unit scored a disappointing 1 hour, 46 minutes.

Verdict

The Lenovo Legion Y540 is a well-built, neatly designed, and capable gaming laptop that does its predecessor proud. If you're in the market for an RTX 2060-powered gaming laptop that costs around ₹1,30,000, then you needn't look any further.

—Vignesh Giridharan

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: 9th Generation Intel Core i7-9750H | OPERATING SYSTEM: Windows 10 Home | GRAPHICS: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 2060 | MEMORY: 16 GB DDR4 2666 MHz | BATTERY: Up to 5 hours | STORAGE: 1TB Samsung PCIe NVMe solid-state drive and HDD upto 2GB (optional) | DISPLAY: 15.6" FHD (1920 x 1080), IPS, up to 144 Hz | WEIGHT: Starting at 2.3kg

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